
CHECKLIST

AI Marketing Readiness Checklist

A practical review of data, workflows, people, governance, use cases, and operational readiness before putting AI into marketing work.

Pulse Analytics Group LLC

Free Resources Library

Before you automate anything, make sure the underlying process is ready.

AI can speed up research, drafting, analysis, classification, customer support, reporting, and many other marketing tasks. But the tool is only one part of the system. If the source data is unreliable, the workflow is unclear, nobody owns the output, or a human cannot catch an important mistake, adding AI may simply make the existing problem move faster.

Use this checklist before adopting a new AI marketing workflow, and revisit it when the workflow changes. A box that does not apply can be marked N/A. A box that cannot be verified should not be treated as complete.

How to use this checklist

For each item, record the evidence behind your answer. Screenshots, sample outputs, process documents, data dictionaries, test results, approval rules, and links to source systems are more useful than simply writing “yes.”

Quick readiness record

AI use case / workflow	_____
Business owner	_____
Primary system(s) / data source(s)	_____
Date reviewed	_____
Review status	☐ Ready ☐ Ready with controls ☐ More work needed ☐ Do not automate yet

1. Define the job before choosing the AI tool

☐ The workflow has a clearly stated business task.

Verify: Write the task as an action and an outcome, not simply “use AI.”

Why it matters: A precise task makes testing and ownership possible.

Common problem: Starting with a favorite AI tool and searching for a problem to solve.

☐ The current process is documented well enough to understand what AI would change.

Verify: Capture inputs, steps, decisions, outputs, and handoffs.

Why it matters: You need a baseline to judge whether the new workflow is actually better.

Common problem: Automating a process that only one person understands.

☐ The expected benefit is measurable or observable.

Verify: Choose measures such as time saved, response time, error rate, throughput, conversion, or review effort.

Why it matters: Without a baseline, improvement claims are difficult to verify.

Common problem: Assuming “faster” automatically means “better.”

☐ The use case has a defined stopping point.

Verify: Identify where AI ends and a person, system, or customer takes over.

Why it matters: Boundaries reduce ambiguity and make failures easier to catch.

Common problem: Allowing an AI workflow to continue indefinitely without a clear handoff.

2. Check the data and inputs

☐ The source data is accurate enough for the intended use.

Verify: Sample recent records and compare them with the source of truth.

Why it matters: AI output can inherit problems from bad or stale inputs.

Common problem: Treating a clean-looking export as proof that the underlying data is correct.

☐ The data is relevant to the task.

Verify: List which fields the workflow actually needs and remove unnecessary inputs.

Why it matters: Less irrelevant context can reduce noise and unnecessary exposure.

Common problem: Sending an entire CRM record when only a few fields are needed.

☐ Sensitive or confidential information has been identified.

Verify: Classify personal, financial, confidential, customer, employee, and proprietary information involved.

Why it matters: Different data may require different controls and contractual treatment.

Common problem: Assuming a public AI interface is appropriate for every dataset.

☐ Data retention, access, and vendor terms have been reviewed.

Verify: Check the current provider documentation and your organization's requirements.

Why it matters: AI services differ in how data is handled and what controls are available.

Common problem: Assuming all AI tools have identical privacy and retention practices.

☐ The workflow has a reliable fallback when source data is missing.

Verify: Define what happens when a required field is blank, stale, contradictory, or unavailable.

Why it matters: Silent guesses can create harder-to-detect errors.

Common problem: Letting the model fill gaps without labeling uncertainty.

3. Test the workflow before production

☐ Representative test cases have been prepared.

Verify: Include ordinary cases, edge cases, ambiguous cases, and known failure cases.

Why it matters: A demo example can hide real-world weaknesses.

Common problem: Testing only the easiest inputs.

☐ Expected outputs are defined before testing.

Verify: Write what a good result should contain and what it must not contain.

Why it matters: Predefined criteria reduce subjective evaluation.

Common problem: Changing the definition of success after seeing the output.

☐ The workflow is tested repeatedly, not once.

Verify: Run a meaningful sample and record failures and corrections.

Why it matters: AI outputs can vary between runs.

Common problem: Treating one successful test as validation.

☐ Human review is tested at the actual point where it will occur.

Verify: Have the intended reviewer inspect real outputs and record what they catch.

Why it matters: A theoretical review step is not the same as an effective one.

Common problem: Assuming a reviewer will notice every issue without a usable review process.

☐ A rollback or shutdown path exists.

Verify: Document how to disable the automation and return to the previous process.

Why it matters: A reversible rollout limits damage when something goes wrong.

Common problem: Deploying first and figuring out how to stop it later.

4. Assign human ownership

☐ One person or role owns the workflow.

Verify: Record who can approve changes, pause the workflow, and resolve exceptions.

Why it matters: AI systems still need accountable ownership.

Common problem: Assuming the tool vendor owns the business decision.

☐ High-impact decisions have an explicit human decision-maker.

Verify: Identify decisions that affect customers, employees, spending, eligibility, reputation, or legal obligations.

Why it matters: Some decisions should not be delegated simply because they can be automated.

Common problem: Confusing prediction or recommendation with authority to decide.

☐ Reviewers know what they are checking for.

Verify: Give reviewers a short QA checklist and escalation rules.

Why it matters: Human review works better when the reviewer has defined responsibilities.

Common problem: Telling someone to “look it over” without criteria.

☐ Exceptions have an escalation path.

Verify: Specify when an issue goes to a manager, legal/compliance contact, subject-matter expert, or other owner.

Why it matters: Unusual cases often need context that the automated workflow does not have.

Common problem: Leaving exceptions in an inbox with no owner.

5. Establish governance and safeguards

☐ Allowed and prohibited uses are documented.

Verify: Write simple rules for acceptable inputs, outputs, tools, and use cases.

Why it matters: People need clear boundaries before a problem occurs.

Common problem: Relying on informal verbal rules.

☐ AI-generated claims are checked against evidence.

Verify: Require source verification for factual, performance, product, pricing, legal, health, financial, or other material claims.

Why it matters: A fluent answer is not evidence that a claim is true.

Common problem: Publishing a confident statement because it sounds plausible.

☐ The organization can identify AI-assisted work when that context matters.

Verify: Decide when internal records or audience-facing disclosure is appropriate.

Why it matters: Transparency expectations vary by workflow and audience.

Common problem: Treating disclosure as either mandatory everywhere or unnecessary everywhere.

☐ Prompt, workflow, and model changes are documented.

Verify: Record meaningful changes and the date they were made.

Why it matters: A change can alter output quality even when the business process looks the same.

Common problem: Changing a prompt or provider without retaining a baseline.

☐ There is a process for reporting and correcting AI failures.

Verify: Record incidents, severity, affected outputs, correction, and prevention steps.

Why it matters: Learning from failures is part of operating the system responsibly.

Common problem: Fixing one bad output and never recording the cause.

6. Review the marketing-specific risks

☐ Brand voice and positioning have been defined for the workflow.

Verify: Provide approved examples, prohibited claims, tone rules, and escalation triggers.

Why it matters: AI can produce technically correct copy that still does not sound like the organization.

Common problem: Assuming a generic style setting is enough.

☐ Customer-facing outputs have a review threshold.

Verify: Define which content can be published automatically and which requires approval.

Why it matters: The cost of a mistake is not the same for every channel.

Common problem: Using one approval rule for a social caption and a contractual statement.

☐ Promotional claims have supporting evidence.

Verify: Keep the source, date, scope, and limitations for important claims.

Why it matters: Advertising claims need substantiation; unsupported AI-generated claims are still advertising claims.

Common problem: Assuming AI-generated wording changes the advertiser's responsibility.

☐ SEO use follows search-engine guidance.

Verify: Review whether the content is genuinely useful, original, and people-first.

Why it matters: Google's current guidance emphasizes helpful content and prohibits scaled content created primarily to manipulate rankings.

Common problem: Publishing large volumes of lightly edited AI pages simply to target more queries.

☐ AI detection scores are not treated as proof of authorship.

Verify: Use provenance, workflow records, source review, and human judgment instead of a single detector score.

Why it matters: AI-detection tools can make accuracy claims that require evidence.

Common problem: Treating a detector percentage as a definitive fact about who wrote something.

7. Launch, monitor, and review

☐ The first rollout has a limited scope.

Verify: Choose a controlled audience, workflow, or volume before broad deployment.

Why it matters: A limited launch makes unexpected effects easier to contain.

Common problem: Turning on an automation for the entire customer base immediately.

☐ Success and failure metrics are defined.

Verify: Record baseline, target, acceptable error rate, and escalation threshold.

Why it matters: You need a way to determine whether the workflow remains useful.

Common problem: Measuring only usage or number of outputs.

☐ Outputs are sampled after launch.

Verify: Set a review frequency appropriate to the risk and volume.

Why it matters: Problems can emerge after real-world inputs change.

Common problem: Assuming successful pre-launch testing means monitoring is no longer needed.

☐ The workflow has a scheduled review date.

Verify: Record when the process, vendor, data, and controls will be reassessed.

Why it matters: AI capabilities and platform policies change.

Common problem: Building an AI workflow once and never revisiting it.

Final readiness review

Use the final page to make the decision visible. “Ready” does not mean the workflow is risk-free; it means the team has identified the relevant risks, tested the process, assigned ownership, and put controls in place that are appropriate to the use case.

Check	Pass	Needs attention	N/A
Business task and expected benefit are clear.	■	■	■
Inputs and data handling are understood.	■	■	■
Representative testing is complete.	■	■	■
Human ownership and escalation are defined.	■	■	■
Marketing claims and customer-facing outputs have review rules.	■	■	■
Search/SEO use has been checked where relevant.	■	■	■
Monitoring and rollback are documented.	■	■	■
A review date has been scheduled.	■	■	■

Evidence / notes

Reference points used in this checklist

This checklist draws on general risk-management and current marketing/search guidance. It is not legal advice and does not replace review of the terms, policies, contracts, or laws applicable to a particular business or use case.

Sources and further reading

- NIST AI Risk Management Framework: <https://www.nist.gov/itl/ai-risk-management-framework>
- NIST Generative AI Profile: <https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/ai/NIST.AI.600-1.pdf>
- FTC Advertising and Marketing Basics: <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/advertising-marketing>
- FTC Workado AI detection enforcement matter: <https://www.ftc.gov/legal-library/browse/cases-proceedings/2323092-content-scale-ai>
- Google Search: AI-generated content guidance: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/using-gen-ai-content>
- Google Search: Generative AI features guidance: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/ai-optimization-guide>